@runnigor HYROX

YOUR FIRST HYROX IN 10 WEEKS

A free guide from Igor, running coach (@runnigor)

WHO IT'S FOR you already train and can run 5 km without stopping. The goal: finish your first HYROX feeling good and without getting hurt.

HOW TO READ IT rules, weights and distances come from the official rulebook. Everything about training (volume, sets, gym weights) is coaching practice, not research. There are no studies yet on the "best way" to train for HYROX. Those parts are marked (coach's recommendation).

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Igor Potseluev, running coach

01 HYROX IN ONE MINUTE

It's an indoor fitness race. You run 1 km, then do one station. Eight times. The stations always come in the same order, in every city. Between the running track and the stations you pass through the Roxzone, the transition area. You go through it 16 times, and that time counts. It adds up to about 1 extra km on top of the 8 km of running.

About half of your race time is running. The typical (median) Open finish is about 1:27 for men and about 1:35 for women. For a first race, a fair goal is to finish, somewhere around 1.5 to 2 hours (coach's recommendation).

Divisions for a first race:

- **Open**: standard weights. This is where most beginners start.
- **Doubles**: you run all 8 km together and split the stations however you like. Mixed pairs use the men's Open weights.
- **Relay (team of 4)**: each person runs 2 × 1 km and does 2 stations, Open weights.
- **Pro**: heavy weights. Not for your first race.

02 STATIONS AND WEIGHTS

Sled weights include the sled. Reps and distances are the same in every division. Only the weights change. Pounds are rounded.

#	Station	Volume	Open women	Open men	Pro women	Pro men
1	SkiErg	1000 m				
2	Sled Push	50 m (4 × 12.5 m)	102 kg (225 lb)	152 kg (335 lb)	152 kg (335 lb)	202 kg (445 lb)
3	Sled Pull	50 m (4 × 12.5 m)	78 kg (172 lb)	103 kg (227 lb)	103 kg (227 lb)	153 kg (337 lb)
4	Burpee Broad Jumps	80 m				
5	Rowing	1000 m				
6	Farmers Carry	200 m	2 × 16 kg (2 × 35 lb)	2 × 24 kg (2 × 53 lb)	2 × 24 kg (2 × 53 lb)	2 × 32 kg (2 × 71 lb)
7	Sandbag Lunges	100 m	10 kg (22 lb)	20 kg (44 lb)	20 kg (44 lb)	30 kg (66 lb)
8	Wall Balls	100 reps	4 kg (9 lb) ball, 2.70 m (8 ft 10 in) target	6 kg (13 lb) ball, 3.00 m (9 ft 10 in) target	6 kg (13 lb) ball, 2.70 m target	9 kg (20 lb) ball, 3.00 m target

Easy way to remember it: Pro women use the same weights as Open men. Target height depends on sex, not division: 2.70 m for women, 3.00 m for men.

Rules that cost beginners time:

- **Lunges**: your back knee touches the floor on every rep. Legs alternate. The sandbag stays on your shoulders the whole time.
- **Wall Balls**: squat below parallel and hit the target, or the rep doesn't count.
- **Burpees**: chest touches the floor, hands no more than 30 cm (about 12 in) in front of your toes, take off and land on both feet.
- **Sled Pull**: pull while standing, and don't step on the line in front of your box.
- On the sleds, burpees and lunges you get one warning, then +15 seconds for each extra fault.
- The SkiErg and the rower are set to damper 6. You can change it.
- Powdered chalk without permission is a 2-minute penalty. Use gloves for grip, or check the rules for your race.
- You can only take your shoes off for Wall Balls.

The rules change a little every season. Read the current rulebook for your division before race day.

03 HOW THE 10 WEEKS WORK

Weeks	Phase	What happens
1-3	Base	Learn the stations, build your running slowly
4	Easier week	30 to 40% less volume, easy effort
5-7	Build	Stations at your division's weights, more running after stations
8	Peak	One race simulation at a controlled effort
9-10	Taper	Volume goes down, intensity and frequency stay. Race at the end of week 10

A 2-week taper with a clear drop in volume, while you keep some intensity, is backed by research in endurance sports. The exact numbers by week below are (coach's recommendation).

Effort scale (RPE 1 to 10)

- **3-4**: easy. You can talk in full sentences. Easy runs and long runs.
- **6**: comfortably hard. You can say short phrases. Tempo and threshold.
- **7**: hard. Just a few words. Intervals.
- **8-9**: close to max. You'll rarely go here in this plan.

Session codes

- **I** intervals or tempo run
- **E** easy run, 30 to 40 min, RPE 3-4
- **L** long easy run, RPE 3-4
- **S** full-body strength
- **H** HYROX session: running plus stations with no rest in between

04 THREE LEVELS: 3, 4 OR 5 SESSIONS A WEEK

Pick your level by the time you have and how well you recover. If you're on 5 days and your legs feel heavy by the weekend, drop to 4. Recovering well matters more than one extra session.

Level	Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
3 sessions	**I**	**S + 15 min station technique**	**L on odd weeks, H on even weeks**		
4 sessions	**I**	**S**	**H**	**L**	
5 sessions	**I**	**S**	**H**	**L**	**E or a second S (alternate)**

How to place them (coach's recommendation):

- Put at least one easy day or rest day between hard days (I, H, the simulation).
- The day after an H session is rest or an easy run.
- Do no more than 1 or 2 HYROX sessions a week. In a survey of about 420 HYROX athletes, knees were the most common injury site and tendon problems were the most common type. The only separate risk factor they found was doing more HYROX-specific sessions per week. Spend the rest of your week on running and strength.
- Sample 4-day week: Tue I, Wed S, Fri H, Sun L.

05 RUNNING SESSIONS BY WEEK

Start every I session with 10 to 15 min of easy running and finish with 10 min easy.

Week	I (intervals / tempo)	L (long easy run)
1	6 × 2 min at RPE 7, 2 min easy jog between	40 min
2	5 × 3 min at RPE 7, 2 min jog	45 min
3	4 × 4 min at RPE 7, 2 min jog	50 min
4 (easier)	4 × 2 min at RPE 7, 2 min jog	40 min
5	2 × 10 min at RPE 6, 3 min jog	55 min
6	5 × 1 km at RPE 7, 2 min jog	60 min
7	20 min steady at RPE 6	65 min
8	6 × 1 km at your planned race effort (RPE 6-7), 90 s to 2 min jog	50 min (shorter in simulation week)
9	4 × 1 km at race effort, 2 min jog	45 min
10	3 × 3 min at RPE 6-7 early in the week	none, just an E run of 20 to 25 min two days before the race

By race day you want to run 8 km at an easy pace without trouble. Add about 5 minutes a week to your long run (coach's recommendation). If 40 minutes is too much in week 1, start at 30 and build the same way.

06 STRENGTH (S)

Stop every set with 2 or 3 reps left in the tank. Your last rep should still look clean. ACSM guidelines for beginners: 2 to 3 full-body strength days a week, 1 to 3 sets of 8 to 12 reps. For muscular endurance, lighter weights for 10 to 15 or more reps.

Exercise	Weeks 1-4	Weeks 5-8	Weeks 9-10
Goblet squat (dumbbell or kettlebell)	3 × 10	3 × 12-15	2 × 8
Dumbbell Romanian deadlift	3 × 10	3 × 12	2 × 8
Reverse lunge (knee lightly touches a mat)	3 × 8 per leg, bodyweight or light dumbbells	3 × 10 per leg, loaded	2 × 6 per leg
Push-ups (hands on a bench is fine)	3 × 8-12	3 × 10-15	2 × 8
One-arm dumbbell row	3 × 10 per arm	3 × 12 per arm	2 × 8
Farmers carry	4 × 40 m, medium weight	4 × 50 m, close to race weight	2 × 40 m
Calf raises	2 × 15	3 × 15	2 × 12
Plank	3 × 30 s	3 × 45 s	2 × 30 s

Rest 60 to 90 s between sets. The second S day on level 5 is the same, but swap the goblet squat for walking lunges and the Romanian deadlift for glute bridges.

07 HYROX SESSIONS (H) AND STATION TECHNIQUE

Station weights (coach's recommendation):

- **Weeks 1-4**: lighter than race weight. A 3 kg ball instead of 4 (women) or 4 to 5 kg instead of 6 (men). A 5 kg sandbag instead of 10, or 10 kg instead of 20. Sleds at about half to two thirds of race weight. Technique first.
- **Weeks 5-8**: your division's weights. If your form breaks down, go lighter again.
- **Sleds**: on a smooth gym floor they usually slide easier than on race carpet. So by weeks 6 and 7, load them until they feel heavier than race weight. Every gym floor is different, so go by feel, not by the number on the plates.
- No sled or SkiErg? Push a heavy plate across the floor or walk uphill with a heavy backpack instead of the sled. Row or jump rope instead of the SkiErg. Not the same, but better than nothing.

Week	H session
1	Technique, fresh: row 3 × 250 m, SkiErg 3 × 250 m (RPE 6), 3 × 10 wall balls, 2 × 10 m lunges with knee touch, 3 × 5 burpee broad jumps, sled push and pull 4 × 12.5 m. Rest as needed
2	3 rounds: 500 m run (RPE 6), row 250 m, 500 m run, 25 wall balls. Rest 2 to 3 min between rounds
3	4 rounds: 500 m run, then one station per round: SkiErg 250 m / sled push 25 m / burpee broad jumps 20 m / farmers carry 50 m. Rest 2 min
4 (easier)	Technique only, like week 1, 2 sets each
5	4 rounds: 1 km run (RPE 6), then half a station: SkiErg 500 m / sled pull 25 m / burpee broad jumps 40 m / row 500 m. Rest 2 min
6	4 rounds: 1 km run, then half a station: farmers carry 100 m / lunges 50 m / 50 wall balls / sled push 25 m. Rest 2 min
7	"Second half of the race": 4 × (1 km + full station) with stations 5 to 8: row 1000 m, farmers carry 200 m, lunges 100 m, 100 wall balls. RPE 7, no rest between rounds
8	Simulation: 8 × (1 km + station) at RPE 7, not all out. Level 3 can do 4 km with stations 1 to 4. The point is to test your pacing, fueling and gear
9	3 × (1 km at race effort + half of any station), rest 2 min
10	4 or 5 days before the race: 2 × (500 m + 20 wall balls), easy. Just to keep the movement fresh

One full simulation per training block is enough (coach's recommendation). It takes a long time to recover from and doesn't add much if you repeat it.

Station technique cues (coach's recommendation)

- **SkiErg**: pull with your trunk and bend your knees a little. Your arms finish the stroke. Hold an even pace from the first minute.
- **Sled Push**: forearms or hands on the posts, elbows bent, shoulders over the sled, body low, short quick steps. Don't push with straight arms.
- **Sled Pull**: take the slack out of the rope before your first pull. Drive with your legs and hips, like a deadlift, and let your arms finish. Lay the rope off to the side so you don't step on it. Keep a steady rhythm, not big pulls with long pauses.
- **Burpee Broad Jumps**: steady rhythm. Jump to save energy, not for distance. Hands close to your toes (30 cm max). You're allowed to step up through one knee.
- **Rowing**: legs, body, arms, then back in the same order. Even pace. Take the first 200 m calmly.
- **Farmers Carry**: shoulders down and back, short quick steps, tight grip. If you need a break, set the weights down. Don't drop them.
- **Lunges**: short step, chest up, sandbag high on your shoulders. Your knee touches the floor gently. It shouldn't slam down.
- **Wall Balls**: ball at your chin, full squat depth, use your legs to send the ball up. Plan your sets before the race, for example 25, 20, 15, 15, 15, 10. Rest 2 or 3 breaths between sets. Don't go to failure.

+ WEEK BY WEEK

WEEK 1 BASE

I 6 × 2 min at RPE 7, 2 min easy jog between

L 40 min

H Technique, fresh: row 3 × 250 m, SkiErg 3 × 250 m (RPE 6), 3 × 10 wall balls, 2 × 10 m lunges with knee touch, 3 × 5 burpee broad jumps, sled push and pull 4 × 12.5 m. Rest as needed

3 SESSIONS	4 SESSIONS	5 SESSIONS
I S L	I S H L	I S H L E/S

WEEK 2 BASE

I 5 × 3 min at RPE 7, 2 min jog

L 45 min

H 3 rounds: 500 m run (RPE 6), row 250 m, 500 m run, 25 wall balls. Rest 2 to 3 min between rounds

3 SESSIONS	4 SESSIONS	5 SESSIONS
I S H	I S H L	I S H L E/S

WEEK 3 BASE

- **I** 4 × 4 min at RPE 7, 2 min jog
- **L** 50 min
- **H** 4 rounds: 500 m run, then one station per round: SkiErg 250 m / sled push 25 m / burpee broad jumps 20 m / farmers carry 50 m. Rest 2 min

3 SESSIONS	4 SESSIONS	5 SESSIONS
I S L	I S H L	I S H L E/S

WEEK 4 EASIER WEEK

- **I** 4 × 2 min at RPE 7, 2 min jog
- **L** 40 min
- **H** Technique only, like week 1, 2 sets each

3 SESSIONS	4 SESSIONS	5 SESSIONS
I S H	I S H L	I S H L E/S

WEEK 5 BUILD

- **I** 2 × 10 min at RPE 6, 3 min jog
- **L** 55 min
- **H** 4 rounds: 1 km run (RPE 6), then half a station: SkiErg 500 m / sled pull 25 m / burpee broad jumps 40 m / row 500 m. Rest 2 min

3 SESSIONS	4 SESSIONS	5 SESSIONS
I S L	I S H L	I S H L E/S

WEEK 6 BUILD

- **I** 5 × 1 km at RPE 7, 2 min jog
- **L** 60 min
- **H** 4 rounds: 1 km run, then half a station: farmers carry 100 m / lunges 50 m / 50 wall balls / sled push 25 m. Rest 2 min

3 SESSIONS	4 SESSIONS	5 SESSIONS
I S H	I S H L	I S H L E/S

WEEK 7 BUILD

- **I** 20 min steady at RPE 6
- **L** 65 min
- **H** "Second half of the race": 4 × (1 km + full station) with stations 5 to 8: row 1000 m, farmers carry 200 m, lunges 100 m, 100 wall balls. RPE 7, no rest between rounds

3 SESSIONS	4 SESSIONS	5 SESSIONS
I S L	I S H L	I S H L E/S

WEEK 8 PEAK

- **I** 6 × 1 km at your planned race effort (RPE 6-7), 90 s to 2 min jog
- **L** 50 min (shorter in simulation week)
- **H** Simulation: 8 × (1 km + station) at RPE 7, not all out. Level 3 can do 4 km with stations 1 to 4. The point is to test your pacing, fueling and gear

3 SESSIONS	4 SESSIONS	5 SESSIONS
I S H	I S H L	I S H L E/S

WEEK 9 TAPER

- **I** 4 × 1 km at race effort, 2 min jog
- **L** 45 min
- **H** 3 × (1 km at race effort + half of any station), rest 2 min

3 SESSIONS	4 SESSIONS	5 SESSIONS
I S L	I S H L	I S H L E/S

WEEK 10 TAPER

- **I** 3 × 3 min at RPE 6-7 early in the week
- **L** none, just an E run of 20 to 25 min two days before the race
- **H** 4 or 5 days before the race: 2 × (500 m + 20 wall balls), easy. Just to keep the movement fresh

3 SESSIONS	4 SESSIONS	5 SESSIONS
I S H	I S H L	I S H L E/S

08 RACE DAY

Pacing (coach's recommendation)

- **Run your first kilometer slower than you want to.** Starting too fast is the most common beginner mistake. For the first few kilometers, aim for half marathon or marathon effort, RPE 6. Not your 5K pace. Your interval pace from training will be about 20 to 30 seconds per km slower in the race, and that's normal.
- GPS watches are often wrong inside an arena. Run by feel and by your lap times.
- **Jog the Roxzone.** Don't walk it. Look at the arena map before the start so you know where each station's entry and exit is.
- Stay even on the rower and SkiErg, smooth on the sleds, and stick to your wall ball plan.
- Still feel strong after 6 km? Pick it up for the last two. Not before.
- Even elite athletes run their last kilometers slower than their first. The best ones slow down the least.

Fueling

- **The night before**: a normal dinner. Nothing new.
- **2 to 4 hours before**: a meal with carbs, low in fiber and fat. For example oatmeal, or white toast with jam and a banana.
- **During the race** (coach's recommendation): if you expect to be out there for more than an hour, take 40 to 60 grams of carbs per hour. Ideally that's 2 gels an hour, on the running parts. For example, your first gel 20 to 30 minutes after the start, then about every half hour. Drink water at the stations when you're thirsty.
- **Caffeine** (coach's recommendation): optional. If you use it, take it either shortly before the start, or during the race around minute 30 to 40. That way it kicks in for the second half, where the heavy stations are (lunges, wall balls). Don't take it later than that. Use the same amount you already use and have tried in training. No experiments on race day.
- The main rule: use only what you've tried in training. That's what the week 8 simulation is for.

Gear

- Running shoes with good grip. The floor on the sleds and in the Roxzone can be different.
- Gloves, if you like them in training. Leave the powdered chalk at home.
- Test everything in your simulation, not on race day.

09 COMMON MISTAKES

1. A mini HYROX every day instead of running and regular strength work.
2. Going out too fast on the first kilometer.
3. Walking the Roxzone.
4. Wall balls to failure instead of planned sets.
5. Training sleds only on a smooth gym floor. Race carpet is harder to push on.
6. Lunges without touching the knee down in training. In the race, it's a rule.
7. A new gel, a new breakfast or new shoes on race day.
8. A full simulation every week.
9. Skipping the easier week 4 because you feel great.

10 STAYING HEALTHY

- In HYROX athletes, knees are the most common injury site, and tendon problems that come on slowly are the most common type. This comes from a survey, not an exact count, but the message is clear: add load gradually.
- **Lunges**: go from 2 × 10 m with no weight to 100 m with a sandbag over weeks, not in one week. Put a mat under your knee in training.
- **Wall Balls**: that's 100 deep squats when you're tired. Get depth and form right with a light ball first, then add reps, then speed.
- **Sleds**: they load your calves, Achilles and lower back. Keep your elbows bent and your back neutral. No jerky pushes.
- **Burpees**: land softly on your whole foot. Don't try to jump for a record.
- Sleep and rest (coach's recommendation): take a rest day or an easy run after a hard H session, and aim for 7.5 to 9 hours of sleep.
- Pain that fades after the warm-up and doesn't come back is usually not a reason to stop. Pain that gets worse during the session, or changes how you move or walk, means stop that exercise and get it checked.

When to see a doctor

- Joint or tendon pain that lasts more than a few days and isn't getting better.
- Swelling, a pop with sharp pain, or a joint that locks or gives way.
- Pain at night or at rest.
- Chest pain, unusual shortness of breath, dizziness or an irregular heartbeat during exercise. Stop right away.
- Numbness or tingling in an arm or a leg.
- If you have a chronic condition (heart, blood pressure, joints), or it's been a long time since your last checkup, see a doctor before you start training.

This guide doesn't replace medical advice or a plan built for you.

Want a plan built around your schedule and your races? Send me a DM at @runnigor.

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